Ishkhan Khchoian

Project Manager — LegalTech & immigration platforms

Yerevan, Armenia · remote, or on-site / hybrid in Yerevan · open to relocation
+374 98 60 34 64 · ishxanxchoyan@gmail.com · linkedin.com/in/ishkhan-khchoian-2419182b3
English (C1) · Russian (native) · Armenian (native)

PROFILE

For three years I was the person your product is built for. As a paralegal and then case manager at U.S. legal services companies I worked inside case pipelines, intake forms, evidence checklists and filing deadlines — up to 12 complex filings at once, with 30 of my clients approved for immigrant and non-immigrant talent visas. At one company I redesigned the delivery process: a strictly six-month cycle, new two- and four-month express tracks, and a 35% higher success rate.

I am currently COO of SayWhen.am, an AI voice-agent startup, where I run development with the CTO and manage the company's corporate clients across the full engagement cycle. I completed an IT project management course through a U.S. Embassy program and am taking the PSM I exam in November 2026. For a legaltech or immigration platform that combination is the point: I speak your customers' language and turn it into tickets, acceptance criteria and a realistic schedule.

WHY ME FOR THIS ROLE

- **I am the end user.** Years inside immigration and civil practice — O-1B, EB-3 and E-2 filings, intake, evidence, submission. I know which part of the workflow practitioners actually hate, and it is rarely the part software vendors fix first.
- **Discovery without a glossary.** Hundreds of structured client intake interviews. Interviewing a paralegal or an attorney about their workflow is a conversation I can hold at full speed.
- **Legal operations, redesigned.** My workflows, templates and checklists became the team standard, and the Paralegal Academy I built went on to serve 50+ people. That is exactly the problem legaltech sells against.
- **Requirements and acceptance criteria.** I reviewed eight specialists' work against written standards every week; in law an ambiguous sentence loses cases, so written precision is a professional habit.
- **Compliance and contracts.** Law degree, civil-contract analysis, claims, and an arbitration court from the inside. Regulatory conversations do not need translating for me.

SKILLS

- **Delivery:** scope and milestone planning · Scrum and Kanban · backlog refinement · risk and dependency tracking · Gantt charts · release coordination · reporting
- **Product & analysis:** user interviews and discovery · requirements, user stories and acceptance criteria · as-is / to-be process mapping · workflow redesign · SOPs, checklists and runbooks
- **Domain:** U.S. immigration filings (O-1B, EB-3, E-2) · case management pipelines · civil contracts and claims · arbitration procedure · legal training and onboarding
- **Tools:** Jira · Confluence · Miro · Notion · Trello · Monday · Bitrix24 · amoCRM · Google Analytics · MS Office

EXPERIENCE

COO — SayWhen.am (AI voice-agent startup) Feb 2026 – present

- Run product development with the CTO in Jira and Confluence: requirements, specification, backlog and priorities, and acceptance of each stage.
- Manage the company's corporate clients across the full engagement cycle: needs discovery, agreement on scope and timelines, and regular progress reporting during implementation.

Freelance — project and legal work Feb 2026 – present

- Designed a U.S. client-acquisition pilot for **Karas Systems** (B2B go-to-market consultancy): a three-scenario funnel model, budget, payback and decision gates.
- Business research for a water production line; CPA/affiliate manager (under NDA); legal projects — IP assignment for works by popular musicians, a corporate structure for a crypto trader and advice on opening a crypto-exchange office in Armenia; sale of family real estate.

Senior Case Manager — M&M Document Preparation (U.S.) Jun 2025 – Feb 2026

- Owned up to **12 complex client projects at a time**, end to end, against fixed external deadlines.
- Redesigned the delivery process: a cycle of **strictly six months or less**, new **two- and four-month express tracks**, fewer errors through a shared knowledge base, and a **35% higher success rate**.
- Coordinated **8 specialists** and reviewed their work against written acceptance criteria; my templates, checklists and hand-off rules became the team standard.

Event / Project Manager — Hosq Corp. Jan 2025 – Jun 2025

- Delivered live events for **100 to 3,000** people — several in parallel, on dates that could not slip; owned vendors, logistics, scheduling and day-of operations.

Project Manager — Qanon Construction Aug 2024 – Dec 2024

- Client communication, scope agreement, timelines and internal follow-through.

Senior Paralegal — Shamayev Business Law Corp. · Paralegal — Bloomrich Law Firm Feb 2023 – Aug 2024

- Built and taught the **Paralegal Academy**, an internal training program that went on to serve **50+ people**, and improved the firms' internal processes.
- Carried key accounts with full autonomy and deputized for the team lead.

Judge's Associate — Arbitration Court Nov 2021 – Dec 2022

- **200+ concurrent cases, 30+ hearings a week**, covering three roles at once.
- Drafted judicial acts, managed case materials and kept document flow moving.

Assistant Lawyer — Bar Association Dec 2019 – Aug 2021

- Civil-contract analysis and claims; legal support to a trade and construction organization.

Project Manager — SIS LLC (family business) Jun 2015 – Sep 2019

- Managed projects including an **investment project made up of 11 public and private tenders worth RUB 42M** — every site delivered **on time and accepted with no defects noted**.
- Teams of up to 20; procurement, logistics between sites and recruiting; built the first schedules and Gantt charts; set up a regional supply network for the retail business.

EDUCATION & TRAINING

- **Project management** — "Project Management with a U.S. Perspective: Skills for Global Success" — Yerevan American Corner, a joint program of the U.S. Embassy Yerevan and the City Central Isahakyan Library; Jul 21 – Aug 21, 2026, in person, Certificate of Achievement.
- **Professional Scrum Master I (Scrum.org)** — exam scheduled for November 2026.
- **Project Management (PM Club)** — 2023, 52 hours.
- **Piscine intensive (C programming)** — 42 Yerevan, Nov–Dec 2025; passed selection and completed it alongside a full-time job.
- **Bachelor of Law, with honors** — North-Eastern State University, 2021.
- **Civil Law, Faculty of Law** — St. Petersburg State University, 2016.

ALSO

- **2nd place, HackNation** local pitches, final at TUMO Labs (July 2026); **Startup Seaside Summit** — participant.
- **Highload++** (700 attendees) — organizing team, led a crew of 12; performance bonus.
- **Ethos Foundation** — HQ coordinator, Sep 2023 – Oct 2024; aid to ~100 families a day.